

Ronin vs Ion – Matchup Overview

Ronin vs Ion plays very similarly to Ronin vs Ronin. It's fundamentally a **brawl matchup** where your main job is to **prevent Ion from creating space**.

Ronin will usually win if you can:

1. **Close the gap** and force a close-quarters fight.
 2. **Block or phase** the majority of Ion's burst damage sources
 - Laser Tripwires
 - Laser Shot
 3. **Land well-placed Leadwall shots** whenever Vortex Shield is down.
 4. **Melee punish Ion** whenever they use Vortex Shield.
 5. **Respect Laser Tripwires** and don't pop them for free.
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Mind Games & Spacing

This fight is very "mind-gamey" - both players are constantly trying to **predict each other's next option**.

Each player is rotating between three main options:

- Firing weapons/abilities
- Using defensive tools
- Using melee to pierce the opponent's defensive

It ends up playing a lot like **rock-paper-scissors**, where each option directly counters another. Your job is to predict what Ion will do based on:

- What you just did
- Where you're positioned
- What tools they have available (Laser Shot, Tripwires, Vortex, etc.)

Ideal spacing:

Stay at a range where you are **one dash length away from landing a melee**.

This spacing:

- Threatens Ion with a **melee punish** whenever they use Vortex.
- Tempts Ion to **try to melee you** when you use Sword Block, which you can then counter.

Counter Guide: Ronin's Answers to Ion's Kit

Splitter Rifle -> Leadwall

- **Counter with:** Leadwall (no Sword Block flicker while they're spraying).
 - If Ion is **spraying**, **mag dump** your Leadwall.
 - **Do NOT flicker block** against spray fire – it actually lets more Splitter shots connect and you'll take more damage.
 - Only flicker Sword Block if you're **preemptively trying to catch an incoming Laser Shot**.
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Laser Shot -> Sword Block

- **Counter with:** Sword Block.
 - Preempt the Laser Shot if you can; flicker block only when you expect the burst.
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Laser Tripwire -> Depends on Range

Close Range

- **Counter with:** Phase Shift
- Phase through the Tripwires to safely pop them.

Mid Range (with Arc Wave Ready)

- **Counter with:** Arc Wave
- Aim the Arc Wave so it both:
 - **Pops the tether**, and
 - **Hits Ion** at the same time.

Mid Range (No Arc Wave Available)

- **Counter with:** Leadwall
 - Shoot the Tripwire from safety with Leadwall.
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Vortex Shield -> Melee

- **Counter with:** Melee
- When Ion pulls up Vortex Shield in your melee range, **dash in and melee** to pierce it and punish.

Avoid Predictability

Ion will punish you hard if he can **predict your melee counters**.

If Ion expects you to dash in and melee, he might:

- **Preempt with Laser Shot**
- **Drop Tripwires in your path**
- **Try to melee-box you** (trading melees in close quarters)

Because of this, you should often **threaten** melee without always committing:

- Sometimes just **dashing forward into melee range** is enough to:
 - Bait Ion into **dropping Vortex Shield**, letting you punish with **free Leadwall damage**.
 - Make Ion **panic-react with abilities** (Laser Shot / Tripwires), which you can then block, phase, or simply avoid.

The key idea:

Use your **dash and melee range as a threat**, not a script. If you become predictable, Ion will start pre-counteracting you with burst damage and traps.

Ion Melee -> Leadwall

- **Counter with:** Leadwall
 - If Ion whiffs a melee or tries to melee from too far, **punish with Leadwall shots**.
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Tripwires, E-Smoke, and Arc Wave Safety

- If Ion has Tripwires available, **do NOT place your Electric Smoke directly on top of them** – they can instantly pop their Tripwires inside your smoke.
 - Also, **do not throw Arc Waves** while you're in Tripwire damage range. You don't want to trade your health just to clear them.
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Advanced Tech: Arc Wave vs Vortex Shield

Skilled Ions will often try to **block your Arc Wave with Vortex Shield**. You can punish this with a melee cancel:

1. **Hold Arc Wave** so Ion sees the animation and reacts.
2. When Ion pulls up Vortex Shield, **dash forward**.
3. **Melee cancel** out of the held Arc Wave:
 - The melee **cancels the Arc Wave animation**.
 - The melee **pierces Vortex Shield** and deals damage.

Result:

- You **keep Arc Wave ready** (since you canceled before firing),
- You get **free melee damage** through Vortex,
- And Ion is now wary of pulling up Vortex Shield too early.\